

Training Institute DPDPA Starter Checklist

Your institute doesn't just teach students — it collects, shares and stores student and parent data every day, often for minors. Work through these ten areas to bring student data, parental consent, communication, LMS tools and retention under DPDPA-ready control.

Student Data

Minors

Parental Consent

Admission Forms

WhatsApp Groups

Student Photos

LMS Tools

Placement Data

Vendor Access

Retention

How to use this: tick what you already do, and turn the unticked boxes into your next actions. Start with minor identification, parental consent and admission-form notice — they remove the most risk for the least effort.

1 Student data collection & minimisation

- ☐ List the student data you collect at enquiry, admission, classes and placement.
- ☐ Collect only what you actually need — drop fields you don't use.
- ☐ Keep one primary student record so you always know what you hold and where.
- ☐ Show a clear notice at the point of collection: what you collect, why, who you share it with, how long you keep it.
- ☐ Avoid collecting extra identity or family data 'just in case'.

2 Identifying minors & age

- ☐ Record each student's age / date of birth so you know who is a minor.
- ☐ Treat 'age not recorded' as if the student may be a minor.
- ☐ Flag which programmes typically enrol students under 18.
- ☐ Apply stronger protection to all data of students under 18.
- ☐ Don't run behavioural tracking or targeted ads at minors.

3 Parental / guardian consent

- ☐ Get verifiable parental/guardian consent before processing a minor's data.
- ☐ Record who gave consent, for what, and when.
- ☐ Use a consent method you can actually verify (signed form, verified contact) — not just a verbal yes.
- ☐ Re-confirm consent if the purpose changes (e.g. marketing, photos).
- ☐ Give parents a simple way to withdraw consent later.

4 Admission forms & enrolment notice

- ☐ Add a short privacy notice to your admission/enquiry form.
- ☐ Keep marketing consent separate from the enrolment form — enrolling is not marketing consent.
- ☐ Don't bundle photo/testimonial consent into the admission signature.
- ☐ Store completed forms in access-controlled storage, not open drawers or shared drives.
- ☐ Tell students/parents how to update or correct their details.

5 WhatsApp groups & class communication

- ☐ Avoid exposing every student's number to the whole group — use broadcast or admin-only posting.
- ☐ Keep separate, purpose-specific groups; don't reuse old batches for new marketing.
- ☐ Get consent before adding students/parents to a WhatsApp group.
- ☐ Don't circulate student photos, marks or fee details in open groups.
- ☐ Remove students/parents from groups when their programme ends.

6 Promotional & placement marketing

- ☐ Get a clear opt-in before promotional WhatsApp/SMS/email to students or parents.
- ☐ Don't reuse old student databases for new-batch marketing without consent.
- ☐ Get explicit consent before publishing a student's name, score or placement.
- ☐ Avoid sharing student results or rank lists publicly without consent.
- ☐ Honour opt-outs across every channel, promptly.

7 Student photos, videos & testimonials

- ☐ Get specific consent before using student photos, videos or testimonials in ads.
- ☐ For minors, get parental consent for any image or testimonial use.
- ☐ Tell students where the content will appear and for how long.
- ☐ Provide a way to withdraw a photo/testimonial later.
- ☐ Don't repurpose class/event photos for marketing without consent.

8 LMS, apps & third-party tools

- ☐ List the LMS, apps, CRM and tools that store or process student data.
- ☐ Check what each vendor stores, where, and whether data trains their models.
- ☐ Put data-processing terms (a DPA) in place with each platform.
- ☐ Disclose the tools you use in your privacy notice.
- ☐ Remove apps and integrations you no longer use, and revoke their access.

9 Staff, tutor & vendor access

- ☐ Give tutors and staff access only to the student data they need.
- ☐ Avoid shared logins — give each person their own account, with MFA.
- ☐ Revoke ex-tutor, ex-staff and ex-vendor access the day they leave.
- ☐ Brief every joiner on student-data confidentiality and DPDPA basics.
- ☐ Review who can access student records at least twice a year.

10 Retention, records & student rights

- ☐ Set how long you keep student records after a programme ends, and delete on schedule.
- ☐ Don't keep student databases 'forever' by default.
- ☐ Publish a simple way for students/parents to access, correct or delete data.
- ☐ Verify identity before acting on a request, and log what you did.
- ☐ Write retention and rights rules down so the whole team applies them consistently.